



White paper:

How agentic AI can answer the storms ahead

A position paper in response to
Prime Minister's Lawrence Wong's
May Day Rally, 2026

May 2026

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Section 1:

Executive summary

Prime Minister Lawrence Wong's 2026 May Day Rally identified two simultaneous crises facing Singapore: an energy supply shock born from the closure of the Strait of Hormuz, and an AI-driven transformation that will reshape every productive sector in the global economy. These two storms converge on a single pressure point that has received insufficient strategic attention: the commercial built environment.

Buildings consume more than 33% of Singapore's electricity and account for over 20% of national carbon emissions¹. Commercial real estate is simultaneously the country's largest controllable energy load, the regulatory focus of the new ISSB-aligned disclosure mandate from FY2025², the subject of the Mandatory Energy Improvement regime live since September 2025³, and exposed to a carbon tax that has seen a 9x increase since 2023 (from S\$5 to S\$45 per tonne)⁴. The Tripartite Jobs Council, announced on 30 April 2026, places every AI deployment in this sector under a structural worker-augmentation test. Four pressures, one convergence point, one twelve-month window for action.

Janus Digital is the operating layer that responds to all four pressures simultaneously. Built on fifteen years of proprietary R&D and protected by 76 granted patents, our fourth-generation platform is a physics-first agentic AI, not a large language model overlay. It sits above any existing building management infrastructure, ingests up to 80,000 streaming data points per building per second, and acts on them autonomously. Across more than 10,000 building datasets in 253 cities and three million connected devices, the platform has delivered an average 29% reduction in energy use, 28% improvement in equipment uptime, 20% extension of asset lifespans, and a 50% reduction in operational risk and incident losses.

The commercial model is designed for institutional uptake, with zero capital expenditure for the asset owner. We provide hardware-agnostic deployment across the heterogeneous ecosystem of building management, HVAC, lighting, security, lift, and metering systems already in place. Janus earns 30% of verified operational savings, and only when buildings save. The owner retains 70%, captured directly to NOI. ESG disclosure data is delivered as a streaming by-product of optimisation, not a separate compliance workstream.

Janus Digital Singapore leads the company's engagement across the Asia-Pacific region under the leadership of our CEO, Joyce Woo, a Singaporean banker with more than 40 years of experience in capital markets and institutional asset management. The commitments in this paper to the Government, the Labour Movement, and the institutional capital, asset management, and operating community are the foundation on which Janus Digital intends to build its presence here.

Sources:

- ¹ [Siemens: Singapore's MEI ready buildings: A practical roadmap. Published 13 April 2026.](#)
- ² [Singapore Government Accounting and Corporate Regulatory Authority \(ACRA\): Extended timelines for most climate reporting requirements to support companies. Published 25 August 2025.](#)
- ³ [Singapore Government Building & Construction Authority: Mandatory Energy Improvement \(MEI\) Regime. Updated 23 April 2026 and Siemens: Singapore's MEI ready buildings: A practical roadmap. Published 13 April 2026.](#)
- ⁴ [Savills: Rising carbon taxes & utility costs in Singapore: The hidden OPEX killer for 2026. Published 19 March 2026 and The Business Times: Carbon tax-liable companies can carry over unused carbon credit offset quota from 2025. Published 11 May 2026.](#)
- ⁵ [Singapore Government Ministry of Manpower: MOM, NTUC, SNEF to form Tripartite Jobs Council to address AI's impact on workers, jobs and businesses. Published 30 April 2026.](#)

Section 2:

Foreword

To the Prime Minister, the Brothers and Sisters of the Labour Movement, and the businesses that build Singapore.

Prime Minister Wong's May Day address called this a moment of two storms: an energy crisis born in the Gulf, and an AI revolution that will reshape every industry on earth. He was right to say neither will pass quickly. He was also right to say that Singapore has been here before, and that the answer is never to retreat. It is to move forward, together.

This document is Janus Digital's response. It is written by a company that has activated Singapore as its operational anchor in Asia, in the spirit the Prime Minister called for: not as observers of the storm, but as participants in the answer.

We believe Singapore is uniquely positioned to convert both storms into a structural advantage. We believe the buildings that line our skyline (the offices, malls, multi-family properties, hospitals, data centres, and manufacturing and distribution sites) are where these two storms collide, and where the next chapter of Singapore's productivity story will be written.

The pages that follow set out how.



Bonaventure Wong,
Co-Founder & Global CEO



Joyce Woo,
CEO, Singapore

Section 3:

The first storm: Energy at the building edge



The Prime Minister was direct. The Strait of Hormuz has been closed for more than two months. Energy infrastructure has been damaged. Even when shipping resumes, recovery will take months. Inflation will rise. Some economies will tip into recession.

Singapore has built genuine resilience at the supply end of this equation: Jurong Island, the rock caverns, and our position as a global trading hub. But the demand end remains exposed. Buildings account for more than 33% of Singapore’s electricity consumption and over 20% of its carbon emissions¹. Commercial real estate alone represents one of the largest controllable energy loads in the country. Every kilowatt-hour saved at the building level is a kilowatt-hour the nation does not have to import, store, or pay shock-cycle prices for.

This is where Janus operates. Our platform is an agentic AI native operating layer that connects to existing building automation and management infrastructure, such as BACnet, Modbus, LonWorks, across whatever vendor ecosystem exists, including Bosch, Honeywell, Schneider and Siemens. It does not replace a single sensor or chiller. The platform has delivered consistent, measurable, verified outcomes across more than 10,000 buildings worldwide.

Verified across 10,000+ building datasets:



* 29% decrease in manual/routine work for admin, maintenance and engineering teams to allow for more high-value work

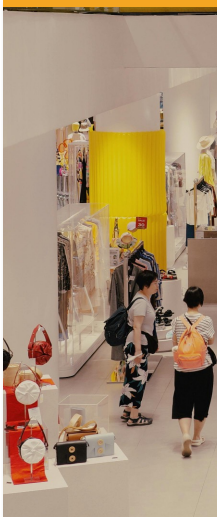
Crucially, owners pay nothing upfront. Janus earns 30% of the verified operational savings. In a stagflationary environment, this is not just a compelling commercial structure; it is a necessity. It is the only AI commercial model that generates immediate cash flow for owners, rather than requiring owners to make capital expenditures.

If half of the commercial floorspace in Singapore adopted this approach, the reduction in energy demand would be material to the national resilience picture, and it would cost the Government nothing.

This is the kind of answer the Prime Minister called for: **built on what Singapore already has, scaled by Singaporean operators, and paid for by results.**

Source:

¹ [Siemens: Singapore's MEI ready buildings: A practical roadmap. Published 13 April 2026.](#)



Case study: Major mixed-use retail and leisure mall operator

Company:

This case study focuses on a single 220,000 square metre flagship mall, owned by one of the world's largest mixed-use retail and leisure operators, a portfolio operator with over 65 million square metres of managed space across more than 200 cities. The mall houses more than 200 retail, hospitality, entertainment, and leisure units, and receives an estimated 20 million visits per year.

Challenge:

Operational complexity at this scale had reached the limits of manual oversight. Energy consumption sat at industry baseline, fault detection was inconsistent, and incident response times of approximately fifteen minutes were exposing both the operator and its tenants to operational and reputational risk.

Outcome:

In pilot deployment, Janus Digital delivered 10% additional energy savings above the existing baseline, a 70% reduction in admin and maintenance workload, 99% system fault detection, response times reduced from approximately fifteen minutes to under sixty seconds, and 98% environmental compliance across all public areas of the asset.

Section 4:

The second storm: From enhanced search to a new lever

Prime Minister Wong made an observation that should be quoted in every boardroom in this country:

“Many say they are using AI like an enhanced search tool. You ask a question, you get an answer. That is a start. But it is really only scratching the surface.”
Prime Minister Lawrence Wong, May Day Rally 2026¹

This is the most important sentence in the speech for any company serious about AI in Singapore.

The Prime Minister also spoke about what comes next: the era of AI agents that "plan and execute complex tasks from start to finish, all on their own¹."

Janus Digital is, precisely, physical AI for the built environment. Our platform does not draft an email about a chiller. It tunes the chiller. It does not summarise a building dashboard. It runs the building. Trained on more than 10,000 building datasets and ingesting up to 80,000 streaming data points per asset every second, the platform acts autonomously, with full operator authority, on the physical systems beneath it.

For two decades, the building industry has chased efficiency through better hardware, better controls, and better commissioning. Each successive lever has compounded, and each has reached its ceiling.

Janus Digital introduces a new lever: an AI-native cognitive layer that finds the optimisation no human, no rules engine, and no static digital twin can find. We do not replace the existing system. We amplify it, and we add a further 20–30% on top of whatever ceiling it had reached.

This is what the Prime Minister meant by going beyond “scratching the surface.” This is the AI Singapore actually needs in its built environment. And it is ready today.

Source:

¹ [Channel News Agency: PM Wong pledges 'new and better' jobs as AI disrupts industries, transforms economy. Published 1 May 2026](#)

Section 5:

Under the hood: The Janus operating layer

Most institutional readers do not need a vendor to convince them that AI matters in real assets. They need to know what makes one AI fundamentally different from another, and what stops a model from confidently producing an output that breaks a building, a tenant's comfort, or a portfolio's reputation.

5.1: Physics over pattern matching

A model trained on the laws of physics, not on language.

Most AI models you have seen (large language models, image generators, document classifiers) tokenise text, pixels, or numbers, and learn statistical patterns. They are powerful. They also hallucinate.

Janus tokenises something different: thermodynamics, fluid flow, and temperature dynamics. The model is trained on the physical behaviour of mechanical systems (chillers, pumps, air handlers, cooling towers, valves) and the building envelope they are housed in. The result is approximately 91% realism to actual physical behaviour, measured against post-deployment instrumentation. More importantly, the model cannot, by its architecture, output a recommendation that violates the laws of physics. It cannot tell a chiller to behave like a kettle. It cannot send hot water down a gas pipe. The constraints of the physical world are baked into the weights themselves.

We describe the model internally as “a PhD in property and physical-world assets.” Once trained on the physics, it generalises across buildings. This is what produces the cold-start advantage: the onboarding window collapses from years of historical data accumulation to a matter of weeks of contextual mapping.

5.2: The live Building Information Model (BIM)

Hardware-agnostic. Vendor-agnostic. One unified, real-time twin.

Buildings are not built on one vendor's stack. They are assembled over decades through retrofits, refurbishments, and successive capital programmes. By the time an asset reaches institutional ownership, it is typically running a heterogeneous ecosystem of dozens of vendor systems across at least seven or eight distinct categories: building management systems from Siemens, Honeywell, Schneider, Johnson Controls, or Bosch; HVAC plant from Daikin, Trane, Carrier, or York; lighting controls from Lutron, Acuity, or Helvar; access control and security from Genetec, Honeywell, or Bosch; lift and escalator systems from Otis, KONE, Schindler, or Mitsubishi; metering and submetering from Schneider, ABB, or Siemens; and increasingly an IoT layer of sensors, gateways, and edge devices from a long tail of specialist suppliers. Each generation of equipment speaks a different protocol. Each vendor has its own data model. Most do not natively talk to each other.

Janus does not ask owners to consolidate. Our platform sits on top of whatever is there, natively translates between vendor systems and protocols, and unifies the entire equipment estate into a single live BIM model, providing a real-time digital twin of the operating asset, which is continuously updated.

In most brownfield assets, no current BIM exists, only outdated 2D blueprints. Where that is the case, our AI builds the BIM from scratch, supported by certified on-site engineers who capture site geometry and equipment topology. The BIM is then maintained as a living model, updated by the operator's engineers as the building is retrofitted, refurbished, or reconfigured, without external specialist intervention.

5.3: Cross domain micro-adjustment 24/7/365

From periodic optimisation to continuous, second-by-second control.

Conventional building energy management runs on schedules and rules. Janus runs on a streaming context. The platform ingests, in real time, not only HVAC telemetry but also: camera feeds, occupancy data, outside humidity and temperature, weather forecasts, and live energy market prices. It correlates them. It acts on them.

The optimisation target is not fixed. For a Grade A office, the objective may be to minimise energy costs at the prevailing tariff. For a five-star hospitality asset, it may be guest comfort within a strict envelope. For a healthcare facility, it may be air quality and pressure differential compliance. Where authorised, agents send setpoint changes directly into the field over the BACnet IP network. Where not authorised, they recommend, and the operator confirms.

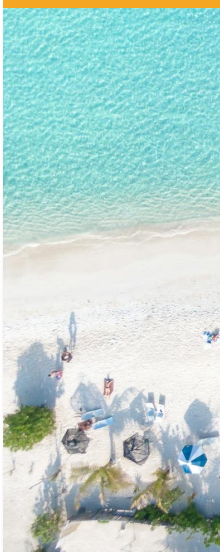
Traditional efficiency levers (such as better hardware, better controls, better envelope materials) have a ceiling. Janus manufactures a new lever by acting in real time on data that the operator could never process manually.

5.4: Onboarding methodology

Operator-led. Train-the-trainer. Two weeks, not two years.

Onboarding is engineered to be fast, replicable, and led by the operator's own engineering workforce. Janus does not deploy its own field engineers as a default. The methodology has four phases:

Phase 1: Audit. Map the BMS estate, validate data quality, and identify dormant or broken systems. Almost every audit reveals that a meaningful share of the existing instrumentation produces alerts that no one reads.



Case study: Luxury beach resort

Company:

A nearly 400-room resort comprising rooms, suites and villas, with multiple high-end restaurants and bars, swimming pools, luxury spa and water park.

Challenge:

The resort did not have a live BIM, only outdated 2D blueprints, and it relied on the building management system (BMS) from one of the biggest global vendors. We needed to verify to what extent the blueprints and BMS platform accurately reflected the asset technology ecosystem in order to complete the roll-out of the Janus platform.

Outcome:

As part of the audit, we identified a significant number of serious anomalies, including identifying specific plant and sensors not recorded on the resort blueprints or the BMS platform including Public Fan Coil Units (FCUs), electricity meters, hot water pumps, Heatcool units, Direct Digital Control units etc.

Overall we reconciled over 3,000 pieces of equipment.

The audit also revealed approximately 20% of the existing BMS was dormant, and alerts that no one was reading, because the engineering team had never been trained to know which data mattered.

With our robust onboarding methodology, we were able to help the resort operators to fully understand the building technology ecosystem. We're now working with them on the next phase of the roll-out.

Phase 2: BIM build. Use existing BIM if present; otherwise, build it AI-assisted from blueprints and on-site capture.

Phase 3: Connect and benchmark. Establish a verified energy and uptime baseline before optimisation is enabled, so every subsequent kilowatt-hour saved is auditable against a known starting point.

Phase 4: Train the trainer. Certify the operator's own engineers to manage the connection layer and on-site labour, replicating Janus capability inside the customer organisation rather than alongside it.

5.5: Real-time sustainability disclosure

From annual audit to streaming truth.

Sustainability reporting has historically been retrospective and audit-based. A building can be a good actor on the day of inspection and a bad actor for the other 364 days of the year. The next wave of Singapore regulation (ISSB-aligned mandatory climate disclosure for STI constituents from FY2025, Scope 3 emissions for Straits Times Index (STI) constituent companies from FY2026¹, the Mandatory Energy Improvement regime live since 30 September 2025, and the carbon tax tripling to S\$45 per tonne on 1 January 2026) will not tolerate that gap.

Janus Digital reframes sustainability as a real-time operational signal. The same telemetry that drives energy optimisation produces continuous, audit-grade emissions data; streamed, not surveyed. Asset managers see portfolio-level carbon intensity in real time. Sovereign wealth funds (SWF) and pension owners can access disclosure-ready data without waiting for the annual cycle.

Compliance becomes a by-product of operations, not a separate workstream.

Source:

¹ [Singapore Government Accounting and Corporate Regulatory Authority \(ACRA\): Extended timelines for most climate reporting requirements to support companies. Published 25 August 2025](#) and [Singapore Government Accounting and Reporting Regulatory Authority \(ACRA\): Sustainability reporting and assurance requirements. Updated 31 March 2026.](#)

Section 6:

The promise: Workers as architects, not bystanders

The Prime Minister's most powerful line was a promise.

“We may not be able to protect every job.
But we will protect every worker.
Because in Singapore, every worker matters.”
Prime Minister Lawrence Wong, May Day Rally 2026¹

He explained that AI has not replaced software engineers at Google, it has promoted them. They are now “architects, orchestrators, system builders¹.” The example he gave from DBS, one of Singapore's largest banks of a long-serving employee who joined as a customer service officer twenty-six years ago and now leads a twenty-person AI-driven team², is the same story. Janus Digital's deployment model has the same logic built into it from day one.

When Janus deploys in a building, the facilities engineering team does not shrink, it is elevated. The repetitive, reactive work evaporates: alarm management, manual setpoint adjustment, compliance reporting, fault-chasing. What remains is judgment: energy policy, predictive asset management, tenant experience, and capital planning. The strategic, technology-aware work that buildings have always needed and never had time for.

Our most sophisticated lighthouse partner said it most clearly during early deployment discussions.

“We don't need your engineers. We have engineers.
We just need to know how to connect to you.”

A Tier-1 Singapore real estate operator

We listened. Our Singapore operating model is built around that exact principle. We do not field a competing engineering force. We certify the existing engineers employed by the asset operators, property managers, and global hospitality and retail groups who run these assets day-to-day, to manage the connection layer themselves. Working through SkillsFuture and the Tripartite Jobs Council framework, announced on 29 April 2026, we will establish a national training pathway that takes Singapore's BMS engineers, M&E contractors, and facility managers into Janus Digital certified connectivity roles that are safer, higher-value, and globally portable.

The property industry has spent a decade moving from asset-heavy to asset-light operating models. Agentic AI is what enables the next step: from asset-light to engineer-light. Buildings that operate autonomously. Engineers who direct and govern, rather than monitor and react. A workforce elevated, not displaced.

This is tripartism written into a commercial model. The Government provides the framework. The Labour Movement secures the upskilling pathways. Companies like Janus Digital provide the platform and the demand. Singapore's engineers, technicians, and facility professionals do the higher-value work that AI cannot — and lead the new categories of work that AI has made possible.

Sources:

- ¹ [Channel News Agency: PM Wong pledges 'new and better' jobs as AI disrupts industries, transforms economy. Published 1 May 2026.](#)
- ² [Singapore Government: Prime Minister's Office: PM Lawrence Wong at May Day Rally 2026. Published 1 May 2026.](#)

Section 7:

The Singapore way, in practice: Three commitments

The Prime Minister called Singapore's "special sauce" tripartism, the trust between Government, Unions, and Employers that, in his words, "others try to copy" but cannot replicate.

Janus Digital's go-to-market in Singapore is built around three commitments to that model.

To Government

We will engage directly with the National AI Council, the BCA 80-80-80 Green Mark mandate¹, the Mandatory Energy Improvement regime, and the Singapore-Asia Taxonomy on building-sector AI adoption. Our verified savings are auditable monthly by any party the Government nominates. We will publish our Singapore results.

To the labour movement

Janus Digital will provide AI tooling and curriculum, at no cost, to NTUC's training arms and the Tripartite Jobs Council, for any building-sector professional enrolled in upskilling programmes. We will hire Singaporean engineers first, and certify them deeply on the platform before deployment.. This is not an internship model dressed up in different language. It is a commitment to the principle that investment in people comes before the extraction of value from them.

To employers

Singapore's institutional capital, asset management, and operating community, its REITs, sovereign wealth funds, pension funds, asset management firms, real estate developers, and global hospitality operators are the "Queen Bee" companies the Prime Minister described. When any major institution in this community adopts Janus, the SME ecosystem behind it (the Mechanical and Electrical contractors, Building Management System specialists, sub-contractors, and facility services firms) is onboarded into the same training and certification at zero cost. The ecosystem shifts together, not in isolation.

This is the Singapore way. **And it is also the Janus Digital way.**

Sources:

¹ [Singapore Prime Minister's Office \(PMO\) National Climate Change Secretariat \(NCCS\): Buildings.](#)

Section 8:

In closing: A commitment to Singapore

The Prime Minister closed with the story of a Singaporean evacuated from Riyadh by the SAF, and the words spoken to him as he boarded: “Welcome home.” He called it a promise¹. Janus Digital is a young company. Our heritage includes more than 10,000 buildings of operating datasets, over three million connected devices, and deployments across 253 cities. Our customer pipeline includes most of the names that matter in Asian real assets.

We are deepening our AI bench with senior global leadership focused on physical-world model development. The mandate is to build best-in-class teams for multiple physical-world AI models, not limited to buildings: healthcare, critical infrastructure, and adjacent domains where the binding constraints are data and capital.

Janus Digital Singapore is activating in May 2026 as the company's anchor in the Asia-Pacific region, led by our Singapore CEO, Joyce Woo. We are hiring in Singapore. We are training in Singapore. We are paying tax in Singapore.

Singapore is also the operating template for how Janus Digital will enter and run every future market. The standards we set here, for engineer certification, for tripartite engagement, for verified savings reporting, will become the model the company applies elsewhere. That is a meaningful commitment to you. It means that the work we do here, and the people we develop here, set the bar for the company globally.

We are not asking for permission to participate in Singapore's transformation. We are committing to deliver it, and to be measured at the standard Singapore demands of every serious operator.

The Prime Minister said the road ahead would be bumpy. He is right. But we believe that Singapore is the country best positioned in the world to convert that bumpiness into a permanent advantage. The energy storm and the AI storm are not separate stories. They are one story. And the place where they meet, building by building, kilowatt by kilowatt, engineer by engineer, is where Janus does its work.

We are ready to do that work. Here. Now. With you.

Majulah Singapura.



Bonaventure Wong,
Co-Founder & Global CEO



Joyce Woo,
CEO, Singapore

Sources:

¹ [Channel News Agency: PM Wong pledges 'new and better' jobs as AI disrupts industries, transforms economy. Published 1 May 2026](#)

About the authors

Bonaventure Wong

Co-Founder & Global CEO



Bonaventure Wong is Co-Founder and Global Chief Executive Officer of Janus Digital. He brings a twenty-year career in global capital markets to the built environment, with senior roles at J.P. Morgan and Morgan Stanley across structured finance, principal investing, and emerging markets coverage. His capital markets work spanned cross-border financings, alternative credit structures, and direct investment in operating businesses across Asia, the Middle East, and Europe, experience that now informs Janus Digital's outcome-based commercial model and its institutional engagement strategy.

He has also co-founded and successfully exited two telecommunications ventures, operating businesses he built from inception to acquisition. Through Janus Digital, he is applying the same operator-led approach to commercial real estate, a sector where institutional capital is increasingly seeking returns generated by running assets better, not by financial engineering.

Bonaventure was educated at Harvard College. He writes regularly on the intersection of artificial intelligence, real estate capital structures, and the economics of running real assets better.

Joyce Woo

CEO Singapore



Joyce Woo is Chief Executive Officer of Janus Digital Singapore Pte. Ltd., leading the company's engagement across the Asia-Pacific region. She brings more than four decades of corporate and private banking experience across Singapore and Southeast Asia, with senior roles spanning credit, operations, compliance, risk management, investment management, marketing, and sales.

Joyce began her banking career as a Credit and Marketing Officer at DBS Finance in 1982. She spent twelve years with Merrill Lynch International Bank, holding regional management positions across banking operations, compliance, and marketing and sales, before joining OCBC Private Bank in 2001 to establish its investment advisory team, where she also served on the investment committee for OCBC Trustee Limited. She subsequently held senior client relationship roles at Citigroup, UBS, Morgan Stanley, and Bank of Singapore.

In 2014 she founded Jachin Capital, a Singapore MAS-licensed fund manager, which was acquired by Leo Capital Corporation in 2023 and rebranded as Leo Wealth Singapore. Joyce served as Chief Executive of Leo Wealth Singapore until 2026. She holds a Bachelor of Business Administration from the National University of Singapore.

About Janus Digital

Janus Digital is an agentic AI company delivering autonomous building intelligence to the world's most demanding institutional asset owners. Built on fifteen years of proprietary R&D and protected by 76 granted patents, the fourth-generation platform operates as a physics-first intelligence layer above existing building infrastructure. It optimises energy consumption, equipment performance, and operational costs in real time, and increasingly surfaces the operational and behavioural patterns that drive revenue, from tenant retention and footfall conversion to dynamic pricing and asset programming. Across more than 10,000 building datasets in 253 cities and more than 800M data streams, the platform has delivered consistent, measurable, verified outcomes for REITs, sovereign wealth funds, pension funds, asset management firms, real estate developers, and global hospitality operators. Janus Digital operates under a distinctive outcome-based commercial model, earning only when its AI delivers verified outcomes against an audited baseline.

Janus Digital Singapore Pte. Ltd. is the company's anchor in the Asia-Pacific region, serving Singapore's institutional capital, asset management, and operating community across REITs, sovereign and pension capital, asset managers, real estate developers, and hospitality operators.

Contact

To request further information about Janus Digital, or to arrange an exploratory discussion with our Singapore team, please write to us at:

engage@janusd.sg

Please include your full name, job title, company name, business email address, and a contact telephone number in your message, together with a brief note on the nature of your enquiry. Our team will respond within two working days.

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